Written by:
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This is it. The final stretch. During this time, I was experiencing personal problems that affected not only my mental health but also my academic performance. Despite all that though, I strived to be even better than last time. It was also the date of our certification exam for Java. I studied the week prior and the night before. On the day of the exam itself, nervous is an understatement for the whirlwind of emotions that I was feeling. Toppled over by my own problems, I forced those thoughts out of my head for just a few hours so I could focus on the certification exam. It was not easy, but Dr. Arlene Valderama has taught us what we know now and failing it, for me, would mean I failed her too. I made sure that I used that as a motivation instead of a burden. Thankfully, I passed and I received my certificate as an official Information Technology Specialist in Java. I was not at the best of my abilities that night, a nervous wreck and carrying the weight of all the problems I had at home. It was more than distracting. It was affecting how I thought and how I acted. But I am glad that I passed it.

I have done it. It may only be my second year, but I take any small achievement as a big one. As long as I have something to show for my hard work, then it is an achievement big enough to be proud of, no matter what it may be. It could be simply a number on a screen indicating my score, or a certificate signifying that I have passed and will be recognized so long as the validity of the certificate remains. Either way, I am proud of how far I have come from the student I was during the prelims to now.

Lastly, Dr. Arlene Valderama. I would like to thank you from the bottom of my heart. I know that I am not your best student, and I know that I have my moments where I am mistaken during class, but if it was not for your efforts to teach me and my coursemates, I would not be where I am now. It may sound very exaggerated, but as I said, I take any and every achievement as one I can be proud of, no matter how small it may be. Thank you so much for your time and patience in teaching us Object-Oriented Programming. I hope that you are also proud of us as students, having grown under your guidance. Again, thank you so much for everything!